

A PREMIUM RECIPE COLLECTION

The Protein Sunrise

20 High-Protein Breakfasts to Fuel Your Morning

20 RECIPES

NUTRITION

RITUALS

by

Dr. Sayali Nahar

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A NOTE FROM THE AUTHOR

Welcome, and Good Morning

"The way you begin your morning shapes the rest of your day."

I wrote this book for anyone who has stood in front of the fridge at 7 AM, short on time and shorter on ideas, wondering how to make breakfast actually count. Over years of working with people on their nutrition, the same question comes up again and again: "What can I eat in the morning that is quick, tasty, and actually keeps me full?"

The twenty recipes in this book are my answer. Each one is built around familiar, everyday ingredients from the Indian kitchen — moong dal, besan, paneer, eggs, curd, sattu, ragi — and each one is designed to give your body a strong, steady dose of protein right from the first meal of the day.

This is not a book about restriction. It is a book about building a sustainable morning ritual: one that supports your energy, your hormones, your muscles, and your mood, one breakfast at a time. I hope these pages become a well-thumbed, curry-stained companion in your kitchen.

With warmth,

Dr. Sayali Nahar

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Dr. Sayali Nahar

Dr. Sayali Nahar is a nutrition and wellness practitioner devoted to making healthy eating feel simple, joyful, and rooted in everyday Indian ingredients. Her approach blends practical nutrition science with the food traditions people already grew up with, so that better eating never feels like a foreign diet.

Through her practice, she has guided people toward sustainable habits around protein, blood sugar balance, and hormonal health — always starting with the most important meal of the day: breakfast.

The Protein Sunrise distills that philosophy into twenty tried-and-tested recipes, built to be cooked on an ordinary weekday morning, with ingredients from an ordinary Indian pantry.

PHILOSOPHY

Food first, supplements second.
Protein at every meal. Progress over perfection.

“

*Breakfast is not just a meal. It is a
promise you make to your body every
single morning.*

— DR. SAYALI NAHAR

FOUNDATIONS

Healthy Eating Guidelines

Simple principles behind every recipe in this book

- ✓ Protein at every meal. Aim for 15–20g of protein at breakfast to curb mid-morning hunger.
- ✓ Pair protein with fibre. Vegetables, legumes and whole grains slow digestion and steady blood sugar.
- ✓ Don't fear healthy fats. Nuts, seeds, paneer and ghee in moderation support hormone health.
- ✓ Hydrate before you eat. A glass of water on waking supports digestion and metabolism.
- ✓ Mind your portions, not just your ingredients — even healthy food adds up.
- ✓ Limit refined sugar at breakfast; let natural sweetness (fruit, jaggery) do the work, in moderation.
- ✓ Cook fresh where possible. Batters and bhurjis taste — and digest — best within a day.
- ✓ Consistency beats intensity. A good-enough breakfast every day outperforms a perfect one once a week.

A NOTE ON NUTRITION VALUES

All calorie and macro values in this book are approximate estimates based on standard ingredient quantities. They will vary slightly with brands, portion sizes and cooking methods — use them as a helpful guide rather than an exact clinical figure.

STOCK YOUR KITCHEN

Grocery Shopping Guide

Everything in this book, organised into one shopping list

PROTEINS

- Eggs & egg whites
- Paneer
- Curd / hung curd
- Milk
- Soya chunks

GRAINS & FLOURS

- Moong dal (split & whole)
- Chana / rajma
- Sattu flour
- Besan (gram flour)
- Whole wheat flour / atta
- Ragi flour / dosa batter
- Rolled oats
- Idli batter / rice
- Multigrain bread

VEGETABLES & AROMATICS

- Onion, tomato, capsicum
- Spinach, carrot
- Ginger, garlic, green chilli
- Fresh coriander & curry leaves

NUTS, SEEDS & EXTRAS

- Peanuts, almonds, walnuts
- Chia & pumpkin seeds
- Makhana (fox nuts)
- Jaggery & honey
- Ghee & mustard oil

SPICES & MASALAS

- Turmeric, ajwain, jeera
- Chaat masala, black salt
- Sambar masala, tamarind
- Cardamom

WORK SMARTER, NOT HARDER

Meal Planning Tips

A few habits that make high-protein breakfasts effortless

BATCH PREP ON SUNDAYS

Soak and grind chilla/cheela/dosa batters for the week and refrigerate in airtight jars. Boil a big batch of chana, rajma and soya chunks together and portion into containers.

FREEZE WHAT YOU CAN

Vegetable & Egg Muffins freeze beautifully for up to two weeks. Bake a double batch and reheat one on any morning you're short on time.

PLAN A ROTATION

Pick 5–6 favourites from this book and rotate them through the week rather than trying all twenty at once — sustainable habits are built on repetition.

KEEP A STANDING LIST

Use the Grocery Shopping Guide as a running checklist — most ingredients here are pantry staples that keep for weeks.

01

The Recipes

*Twenty high-protein breakfasts, organised for easy
everyday cooking.*

7



RECIPE NO. 01

01

Moong Dal Chilla with Paneer Filling

A soft, savoury lentil crepe folded around melting cottage cheese



240 CALORIES	18g PROTEIN	24g CARBS	8g FAT	10 min PREP	10 min COOK	1 SERVES
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- HIGH PROTEIN
- PCOS FRIENDLY
- DIABETES FRIENDLY
- GLUTEN-FREE

Best Time to Eat: Breakfast, between 7-9 AM, or as a light pre-workout meal.

INGREDIENTS

- ✓ 1/2 cup soaked yellow moong dal
- ✓ 50g crumbled paneer
- ✓ Green chilli, ginger, coriander

HEALTH BENEFITS

Moong dal is an easily-digested plant protein rich in fibre, folate and potassium, while paneer adds slow-digesting casein protein and calcium for stronger bones and lasting satiety.

MOONG DAL CHILLA WITH PANEER FILLING**Method & Finishing Touches****METHOD**

Grind soaked dal with ginger and chilli into a batter. Pour on a hot tawa, spread thin, add crumbled paneer on top, fold and cook both sides until golden.

STORAGE TIPS

Batter keeps refrigerated in an airtight container for up to 24 hours. Cooked chillas are best eaten fresh, but can be refrigerated for a day and reheated on a tawa.

PRO TIPS

Let the ground batter rest for 10 minutes before cooking — it spreads thinner and turns crisper at the edges.

“Serve with a spoon of mint-coriander chutney and a wedge of lemon; the acidity cuts beautifully through the richness of the paneer.”

RECIPE NO. 02

02

Besan (Gram Flour) Chilla

A crisp, golden gram-flour pancake studded with vegetables



200 CALORIES	12g PROTEIN	22g CARBS	7g FAT	8 min PREP	8 min COOK	1 SERVES
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- WEIGHT LOSS
- VEGETARIAN
- GLUTEN-FREE
- DIABETES FRIENDLY

Best Time to Eat: Breakfast, between 7-9 AM, or as a light evening snack.

INGREDIENTS

- ✓ 1/2 cup besan
- ✓ Chopped onion, tomato, coriander
- ✓ Turmeric, ajwain

HEALTH BENEFITS

Gram flour is low on the glycemic index and rich in soluble fibre, which helps steady blood sugar, while ajwain aids digestion and turmeric brings anti-inflammatory benefits.

BESAN (GRAM FLOUR) CHILLA

Method & Finishing Touches

METHOD

Mix besan with water to a smooth batter, add chopped vegetables and spices. Pour on hot tawa, cook both sides with a few drops of oil until crisp.

STORAGE TIPS

Batter stays fresh in the refrigerator for up to a day in an airtight container. Cook fresh where possible for the crispest texture.

PRO TIPS

Keep the batter slightly thin and pour a very thin layer — this is what gives besan chilla its signature lacy, crisp edge.

“A drizzle of tamarind chutney or a side of curd turns this simple chilla into a complete, satisfying plate.”

RECIPE NO. 03

03

Egg Bhurji with Multigrain Toast

Classic spiced scrambled eggs paired with warm multigrain toast

**260**

CALORIES

20g

PROTEIN

16g

CARBS

14g

FAT

5 min

PREP

8 min

COOK

1

SERVES

HIGH PROTEIN

MUSCLE BUILDING

POST-WORKOUT

Best Time to Eat: Breakfast, ideally between 7-9 AM, or as a post-workout meal.

INGREDIENTS

- ✓ 2 eggs
- ✓ Chopped onion, tomato, green chilli
- ✓ 1 slice multigrain bread, toasted

HEALTH BENEFITS

Eggs provide complete, high-quality protein along with choline for brain health, while multigrain bread contributes fibre and slow-release carbohydrates for sustained energy.

EGG BHURJI WITH MULTIGRAIN TOAST

Method & Finishing Touches

METHOD

Sauté onion, tomato and chilli lightly, add beaten eggs and scramble until cooked. Serve hot with toasted multigrain bread.

STORAGE TIPS

Best enjoyed immediately. If needed, egg bhurji can be refrigerated for up to a day and gently reheated in a pan.

PRO TIPS

Cook the eggs on low-medium heat and remove from the pan just before fully set — residual heat finishes the job and keeps them soft.

“A final crack of black pepper and a few fresh coriander leaves right before serving lift the aroma instantly.”

RECIPE NO. 04

04

Sprouted Moong & Peanut Salad Bowl

A crunchy, tangy protein bowl that takes minutes to put together

**220**

CALORIES

14g

PROTEIN

24g

CARBS

8g

FAT

8 min

PREP

2 min

COOK

1

SERVES

WEIGHT LOSS

PCOS FRIENDLY

GLUTEN-FREE

HIGH PROTEIN

Best Time to Eat: Breakfast or as a light mid-morning snack, best eaten fresh.

INGREDIENTS

- ✓ 1 cup sprouted moong
- ✓ 2 tbsp roasted peanuts, crushed
- ✓ Lemon juice, chaat masala

HEALTH BENEFITS

Sprouting increases the bioavailability of nutrients in moong and boosts its vitamin C content, while peanuts add healthy fats and extra plant protein for a well-rounded, fibre-rich bowl.

SPROUTED MOONG & PEANUT SALAD BOWL**Method & Finishing Touches****METHOD**

Lightly steam sprouts, mix with crushed peanuts, lemon juice and chaat masala. Serve fresh as a crunchy protein bowl.

STORAGE TIPS

Best assembled and eaten fresh. Steamed sprouts alone can be refrigerated for up to 2 days in an airtight box.

PRO TIPS

Steam the sprouts only very briefly — 2 minutes is enough to soften them slightly while keeping their signature crunch.

"Finish with a scatter of pomegranate seeds for a jewel-toned pop of colour and a touch of natural sweetness."

RECIPE NO. 05

05

Paneer Paratha with Curd

A hearty stuffed flatbread finished with a cooling side of curd

**300**

CALORIES

16g

PROTEIN

32g

CARBS

12g

FAT

15 min

PREP

12 min

COOK

1

SERVES

HIGH PROTEIN

MUSCLE BUILDING

KID-FRIENDLY

Best Time to Eat: A more filling breakfast, best suited to mornings between 7-9 AM before an active day.

INGREDIENTS

- ✓ 1 whole wheat paratha stuffed with 50g crumbled paneer
- ✓ Mild spices (jeera, coriander)
- ✓ 2 tbsp curd (side)

HEALTH BENEFITS

Whole wheat provides fibre and B vitamins, paneer adds protein and calcium, and the side of curd brings gut-friendly probiotics — together making this a satisfying, well-balanced meal.

PANEER PARATHA WITH CURD

Method & Finishing Touches

METHOD

Mix crumbled paneer with spices for stuffing. Roll into wheat dough, cook on tawa with a little ghee until golden. Serve with curd.

STORAGE TIPS

Best served fresh and hot. Leftover cooked paratha can be refrigerated for a day and reheated on a tawa until warmed through.

PRO TIPS

Seal the edges of the stuffed dough firmly before rolling to prevent the paneer filling from spilling out while cooking.

"A small dollop of homemade white butter melting over the hot paratha is the traditional touch that makes this dish feel indulgent."

“

Small, protein-rich breakfasts, eaten consistently, do more for your body than any occasional perfect meal.

— DR. SAYALI NAHAR

RECIPE NO. 06

06

Greek-Style Hung Curd with Nuts & Seeds

Thick, strained curd topped with crunchy nuts and a whisper of honey

**210**

CALORIES

15g

PROTEIN

14g

CARBS

10g

FAT

10 min

PREP

0 min

COOK

1

SERVES

HIGH PROTEIN

PCOS FRIENDLY

WEIGHT LOSS

GLUTEN-FREE

Best Time to Eat: Breakfast, or a cooling mid-morning bowl in warmer weather.

INGREDIENTS

- ✓ 1/2 cup hung curd
- ✓ 1 tbsp mixed nuts (almonds, walnuts)
- ✓ 1 tsp pumpkin/chia seeds
- ✓ Drizzle of honey

HEALTH BENEFITS

Hung curd concentrates protein and probiotics for gut health, while nuts and seeds add omega-3 fats, magnesium and healthy crunch, making this a nutrient-dense start to the day.

GREEK-STYLE HUNG CURD WITH NUTS & SEEDS

Method & Finishing Touches

METHOD

Strain curd overnight in a muslin cloth to get hung curd. Top with chopped nuts, seeds and a light honey drizzle before serving.

STORAGE TIPS

Hung curd keeps well refrigerated for 2-3 days in an airtight container. Add nuts, seeds and honey only just before serving to keep them crisp.

PRO TIPS

Use full-fat curd for straining — it yields a thicker, creamier hung curd with a naturally rounder flavour.

"A pinch of crushed cardamom or a few saffron strands stirred through turns this into a dessert-like breakfast bowl."

RECIPE NO. 07

07

Sattu Paratha

A rustic Bihari-style flatbread stuffed with roasted gram flour

**280**

CALORIES

16g

PROTEIN

30g

CARBS

10g

FAT

15 min

PREP

12 min

COOK

1

SERVES

HIGH PROTEIN

MUSCLE BUILDING

PCOS FRIENDLY

Best Time to Eat: A hearty breakfast between 7-9 AM, ideal before a physically active morning.

INGREDIENTS

- ✓ 1/4 cup roasted gram (sattu) flour
- ✓ Whole wheat dough
- ✓ Green chilli, ajwain, mustard oil

HEALTH BENEFITS

Sattu is naturally rich in plant protein, fibre and slow-release carbohydrates, and is traditionally valued for its cooling, digestion-friendly properties — a favourite in Indian nutrition circles for hormonal balance.

SATTU PARATHA

Method & Finishing Touches

METHOD

Mix sattu with chilli, ajwain and a little mustard oil to make stuffing. Stuff into wheat dough, roll and cook on tawa with ghee until crisp.

STORAGE TIPS

Best cooked and served fresh. Dry sattu stuffing mix can be prepared a day ahead and refrigerated in an airtight container.

PRO TIPS

Use cold water while kneading the stuffing so the mustard oil's pungency stays sharp and doesn't turn bitter on the tawa.

"Serve with a spoon of tangy mango pickle — the classic Bihari pairing that balances the earthy sattu beautifully."

RECIPE NO. 08

08

Oats & Peanut Butter Bowl

A warm, creamy bowl of oats swirled with nutty peanut butter



250 CALORIES	13g PROTEIN	28g CARBS	11g FAT	3 min PREP	5 min COOK	1 SERVES
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- HIGH PROTEIN
- MUSCLE BUILDING
- DIABETES FRIENDLY
- POST-WORKOUT

Best Time to Eat: Breakfast, especially useful as a quick pre- or post-workout meal.

INGREDIENTS

- ✓ 1/2 cup rolled oats
- ✓ 1 tbsp peanut butter
- ✓ 1/2 cup milk

HEALTH BENEFITS

Oats are rich in beta-glucan fibre, which supports heart health and steadier blood sugar, while peanut butter adds healthy fats and extra protein for lasting fullness.

OATS & PEANUT BUTTER BOWL**Method & Finishing Touches****METHOD**

Cook oats with milk on low flame for 5 minutes until soft. Stir in peanut butter before serving warm.

STORAGE TIPS

Best eaten fresh and warm. Dry oats can be pre-portioned in jars for a quicker morning routine.

PRO TIPS

Stir the peanut butter in off the heat — this keeps its flavour rounder and prevents it from separating.

“A few sliced bananas or a scatter of dark chocolate shavings make this feel like a treat while keeping it wholesome.”

RECIPE NO. 09

09

Boiled Chana Chaat

A zesty, fibre-rich chickpea salad that doubles as breakfast or snack



190 CALORIES	11g PROTEIN	30g CARBS	3g FAT	10 min PREP	0 min COOK	1 SERVES
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- WEIGHT LOSS
- HIGH PROTEIN
- DIABETES FRIENDLY
- GLUTEN-FREE

Best Time to Eat: Breakfast, or as a light and filling mid-morning snack.

INGREDIENTS

- ✓ 1 cup boiled chickpeas (chana)
- ✓ Chopped onion, tomato, coriander
- ✓ Lemon juice, chaat masala

HEALTH BENEFITS

Chickpeas are an excellent source of plant protein and soluble fibre, which supports digestion and helps maintain steady energy levels through the morning.

BOILED CHANA CHAAT**Method & Finishing Touches****METHOD**

Mix boiled chana with chopped vegetables, lemon juice and chaat masala. Toss well and serve fresh as a filling protein snack.

STORAGE TIPS

Boiled chana keeps refrigerated for up to 3 days. Toss with vegetables and lemon juice only just before serving to keep it fresh and crisp.

PRO TIPS

Pat the boiled chana dry before mixing — this helps the chaat masala cling and keeps the salad from turning watery.

"A few crushed papdi or roasted peanuts scattered on top add a satisfying crunch without much extra effort."

RECIPE NO. 10

10

Idli with Sambar

Soft steamed rice cakes served with a warm, tangy lentil stew



230 CALORIES	10g PROTEIN	38g CARBS	4g FAT	10 min PREP	15 min COOK	1 SERVES
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- WEIGHT LOSS
- GLUTEN-FREE
- DIABETES FRIENDLY

Best Time to Eat: Breakfast, traditionally enjoyed hot between 7-9 AM.

INGREDIENTS

- ✓ 3 medium idlis
- ✓ 1 cup mixed vegetable sambar (toor dal based)

HEALTH BENEFITS

Fermented idli batter is easier to digest and supports gut health, while the toor dal sambar contributes plant protein, fibre and a wide range of vegetable micronutrients.

IDLI WITH SAMBAR

Method & Finishing Touches

METHOD

Steam idlis for 10 minutes. Cook toor dal with vegetables, tamarind and sambar masala until soft. Serve idlis hot with sambar.

STORAGE TIPS

Sambar keeps refrigerated for up to 2 days and reheats well. Idlis are best steamed fresh, though leftover idlis can be refrigerated for a day and re-steamed.

PRO TIPS

Rest the idli batter a few extra minutes after steaming before unmoulding — it helps them hold their shape and stay light.

“A final tempering of mustard seeds, curry leaves and a pinch of asafoetida in hot ghee poured over the sambar makes all the difference.”

“

*Your morning plate is the first
conversation you have with your
body each day — make it a kind one.*

— DR. SAYALI NAHAR

RECIPE NO. 11

11

Paneer Bhurji Wrap

A protein-packed wrap filled with spiced, crumbled paneer

**270**

CALORIES

18g

PROTEIN

24g

CARBS

12g

FAT

10 min

PREP

8 min

COOK

1

SERVES

HIGH PROTEIN

MUSCLE BUILDING

POST-WORKOUT

Best Time to Eat: Breakfast on the go, or a quick post-workout meal.

INGREDIENTS

- ✓ 100g crumbled paneer
- ✓ Chopped capsicum, onion, tomato
- ✓ 1 whole wheat roti/wrap

HEALTH BENEFITS

Paneer offers slow-digesting casein protein and calcium, while the whole wheat wrap and sautéed vegetables add fibre, keeping you full and energised through a busy morning.

PANEER BHURJI WRAP

Method & Finishing Touches

METHOD

Sauté vegetables lightly, add crumbled paneer and mild spices, cook for 5 minutes. Roll into a warm wheat roti and serve.

STORAGE TIPS

The paneer bhurji filling keeps refrigerated for a day. Assemble the wrap fresh just before eating so the roti doesn't turn soggy.

PRO TIPS

Warm the wheat roti briefly on a tawa right before rolling — a pliable, warm wrap is far easier to fold without tearing.

“A smear of mint chutney or a few pickled onions inside the wrap add a bright, tangy contrast to the rich paneer filling.”

RECIPE NO. 12

12

Ragi Dosa with Peanut Chutney

A crisp, earthy finger-millet crepe paired with nutty chutney

**220**

CALORIES

9g

PROTEIN

32g

CARBS

7g

FAT

10 min

PREP

10 min

COOK

1

SERVES

GLUTEN-FREE

DIABETES FRIENDLY

PCOS FRIENDLY

WEIGHT LOSS

Best Time to Eat: Breakfast, between 7-9 AM.

INGREDIENTS

- ✓ 1 cup ragi dosa batter
- ✓ 2 tbsp peanuts, garlic, tamarind (chutney)

HEALTH BENEFITS

Ragi (finger millet) is naturally rich in calcium and fibre and has a low glycemic index, making this dosa a gentle, steady source of energy that is especially valued for bone and blood sugar health.

RAGI DOSA WITH PEANUT CHUTNEY

Method & Finishing Touches

METHOD

Spread ragi batter thin on a hot tawa, cook with a little oil until crisp. Blend peanuts, garlic and tamarind for chutney. Serve together.

STORAGE TIPS

Ragi batter keeps refrigerated for up to 2 days. Peanut chutney can be stored in an airtight container in the refrigerator for 3 days.

PRO TIPS

Let the tawa get properly hot before pouring the batter — this is the secret to a lacy, evenly crisp ragi dosa.

"A small side of coconut chutney alongside the peanut chutney offers a lovely contrast of textures and flavours."

RECIPE NO. 13

13

Milk with Roasted Makhana (Fox Nuts)

Warm spiced milk served alongside crunchy roasted fox nuts



180 CALORIES	8g PROTEIN	22g CARBS	6g FAT	5 min PREP	5 min COOK	1 SERVES
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- WEIGHT LOSS
- GLUTEN-FREE
- KID-FRIENDLY
- PCOS FRIENDLY

Best Time to Eat: A light breakfast, or a soothing bedtime snack.

INGREDIENTS

- ✓ 1 cup milk
- ✓ 1/2 cup roasted makhana
- ✓ Pinch of cardamom

HEALTH BENEFITS

Makhana is low in calories yet rich in magnesium and antioxidants, while warm milk provides protein and calcium — a light, comforting combination that is easy on digestion.

MILK WITH ROASTED MAKHANA (FOX NUTS)**Method & Finishing Touches****METHOD**

Dry roast makhana until crisp. Warm milk with cardamom and serve makhana on the side or lightly soaked in the milk.

STORAGE TIPS

Roasted makhana stays crisp for up to a week when stored in an airtight container at room temperature. Warm the milk fresh each time.

PRO TIPS

Dry roast the makhana on low flame, stirring constantly — this keeps it crunchy all the way through without any bitter, over-browned notes.

"A few crushed saffron strands stirred into the warm milk turn this humble bowl into something quite special."

RECIPE NO. 14

14

Vegetable & Egg Muffins

Fluffy baked egg muffins loaded with colourful vegetables



240 CALORIES	16g PROTEIN	12g CARBS	14g FAT	10 min PREP	18 min COOK	1 SERVES
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- HIGH PROTEIN
- WEIGHT LOSS
- MUSCLE BUILDING
- GLUTEN-FREE

Best Time to Eat: Breakfast, or a make-ahead grab-and-go option for busy mornings.

INGREDIENTS

- ✓ 2 eggs
- ✓ Chopped spinach, capsicum, onion
- ✓ Salt, pepper

HEALTH BENEFITS

Eggs deliver complete protein and essential vitamins, while spinach and capsicum add iron, vitamin C and fibre — making these muffins a nutrient-dense, low-carb way to start the day.

VEGETABLE & EGG MUFFINS

Method & Finishing Touches

METHOD

Whisk eggs with chopped vegetables, salt and pepper. Pour into a greased muffin tin and bake at 180°C for 15–18 minutes until set.

STORAGE TIPS

Egg muffins keep well refrigerated in an airtight container for up to 3 days, or frozen for up to 2 weeks. Reheat gently before serving.

PRO TIPS

Grease the muffin tin generously and let the muffins cool for a minute before unmoulding — this keeps them from sticking or tearing.

“Bake a double batch on a Sunday and keep them ready in the fridge for an effortless protein-rich breakfast all week.”

RECIPE NO. 15

15

Rajma (Kidney Bean) Salad Bowl

A light, tangy kidney bean bowl bursting with fresh vegetables



210 CALORIES	12g PROTEIN	32g CARBS	4g FAT	10 min PREP	0 min COOK	1 SERVES
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- HIGH PROTEIN
- WEIGHT LOSS
- GLUTEN-FREE
- DIABETES FRIENDLY

Best Time to Eat: Breakfast, or a light lunchtime bowl.

INGREDIENTS

- ✓ 1 cup boiled rajma
- ✓ Chopped onion, tomato, coriander
- ✓ Lemon juice, cumin powder

HEALTH BENEFITS

Kidney beans are rich in plant protein, fibre and iron, supporting steady energy and fullness, while lemon juice adds vitamin C that helps the body absorb the iron more effectively.

RAJMA (KIDNEY BEAN) SALAD BOWL**Method & Finishing Touches****METHOD**

Mix boiled rajma with chopped vegetables, lemon juice and cumin powder. Toss well and serve as a light, protein rich bowl.

STORAGE TIPS

Boiled rajma keeps refrigerated for up to 3 days. Combine with vegetables and lemon juice just before serving for the freshest taste.

PRO TIPS

Toss the rajma while it's still slightly warm — it absorbs the lemon juice and cumin flavours far better than when cold.

"A handful of pomegranate seeds or chopped cucumber adds welcome crunch and colour to the bowl."

“

*Traditional ingredients, used
thoughtfully, are often the most
powerful nutrition tools we have.*

— DR. SAYALI NAHAR

RECIPE NO. 16

16

Soya Chunk Bhurji

Minced soya chunks simmered with onion, tomato and warm spices



230 CALORIES	19g PROTEIN	20g CARBS	8g FAT	10 min PREP	8 min COOK	1 SERVES
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- HIGH PROTEIN
- MUSCLE BUILDING
- WEIGHT LOSS

Best Time to Eat: Breakfast, or a hearty post-workout meal.

INGREDIENTS

- ✓ 1/2 cup soaked & boiled soya chunks, minced
- ✓ Chopped onion, tomato, ginger-garlic
- ✓ Mild spices

HEALTH BENEFITS

Soya chunks are one of the richest plant-based sources of complete protein, and pairing them with iron-rich ginger-garlic tomato masala makes this a filling, muscle-friendly vegetarian dish.

SOYA CHUNK BHURJI

Method & Finishing Touches

METHOD

Sauté onion, ginger-garlic and tomato, add minced soya chunks and spices. Cook for 6–8 minutes until well combined. Serve hot with roti or toast.

STORAGE TIPS

Soya chunk bhurji keeps refrigerated for up to 2 days and reheats well on a stovetop with a splash of water.

PRO TIPS

Squeeze out excess water from the soaked soya chunks before mincing — this helps them absorb the masala flavours fully during cooking.

“Serve alongside warm roti or toast with a wedge of lime for a bright finishing note.”

RECIPE NO. 17

17

Curd & Roasted Chana Bowl

Cooling curd topped with crunchy roasted chickpeas and spice



200 CALORIES	13g PROTEIN	26g CARBS	5g FAT	5 min PREP	0 min COOK	1 SERVES
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- HIGH PROTEIN
- PCOS FRIENDLY
- WEIGHT LOSS
- GLUTEN-FREE

Best Time to Eat: Breakfast, or a light and cooling snack any time of day.

INGREDIENTS

- ✓ 1/2 cup curd
- ✓ 1/4 cup roasted chana
- ✓ Roasted jeera powder, black salt

HEALTH BENEFITS

Curd provides probiotics and calcium for gut and bone health, while roasted chana adds plant protein and fibre, and roasted jeera aids digestion.

CURD & ROASTED CHANA BOWL**Method & Finishing Touches****METHOD**

Mix curd with roasted jeera powder and black salt. Top with roasted chana just before eating for crunch.

STORAGE TIPS

Curd and roasted chana are best stored separately and combined just before eating so the chana keeps its crunch.

PRO TIPS

Whisk the curd smooth before mixing in the spices — it gives the bowl a silkier, more even texture.

"A few chopped mint leaves and a light drizzle of raw honey add a refreshing twist to this simple bowl."

RECIPE NO. 18

Whole Moong Dal Cheela with Vegetables

18

A wholesome green-lentil crepe folded with grated vegetables



230 CALORIES	15g PROTEIN	28g CARBS	6g FAT	10 min PREP	10 min COOK	1 SERVES
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- HIGH PROTEIN
- PCOS FRIENDLY
- DIABETES FRIENDLY
- GLUTEN-FREE

Best Time to Eat: Breakfast, between 7-9 AM.

INGREDIENTS

- ✓ 1/2 cup soaked whole moong dal
- ✓ Grated carrot, chopped spinach
- ✓ Ginger, green chilli

HEALTH BENEFITS

Whole moong dal retains its fibre-rich husk for slower digestion and better blood sugar control, while carrot and spinach add beta-carotene, iron and additional fibre.

WHOLE MOONG DAL CHEELA WITH VEGETABLES

Method & Finishing Touches

METHOD

Grind soaked moong with ginger and chilli into a batter, fold in grated carrot and spinach. Cook on tawa like a chilla until golden on both sides.

STORAGE TIPS

Batter keeps refrigerated in an airtight container for up to 24 hours. Cook fresh for the best texture and colour.

PRO TIPS

Grate the carrot finely so it cooks through fully in the short time the cheela spends on the tawa.

"A side of curd or a light mint chutney rounds out the plate and adds a cooling contrast."

RECIPE NO. 19

19

Peanut & Jaggery Chikki Smoothie

A creamy, naturally-sweetened smoothie inspired by classic chikki



260 CALORIES	10g PROTEIN	34g CARBS	10g FAT	5 min PREP	0 min COOK	1 SERVES
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- MUSCLE BUILDING
- KID-FRIENDLY
- POST-WORKOUT

Best Time to Eat: Breakfast on busy mornings, or a quick pre-workout energy boost.

INGREDIENTS

- ✓ 1 cup milk
- ✓ 2 tbsp roasted peanuts
- ✓ 1 tsp jaggery
- ✓ Pinch of cardamom

HEALTH BENEFITS

Peanuts contribute healthy fats and plant protein, milk adds calcium and protein, and jaggery offers iron and trace minerals along with natural sweetness — though it should be enjoyed in moderation.

PEANUT & JAGGERY CHIKKI SMOOTHIE

Method & Finishing Touches

METHOD

Blend milk, roasted peanuts, jaggery and cardamom until smooth. Serve chilled or at room temperature as a quick protein shake.

STORAGE TIPS

Best blended fresh and consumed immediately for the smoothest texture. Not recommended for storing beyond a few hours.

PRO TIPS

Use roasted, unsalted peanuts and blend thoroughly for a silky texture without any grainy bits.

"A light dusting of crushed pistachios on top adds colour and a pleasant textural contrast to this creamy smoothie."

RECIPE NO. 20

20

Egg White & Vegetable Omelette

A light, lean omelette packed with colourful vegetables



180 CALORIES	18g PROTEIN	10g CARBS	6g FAT	5 min PREP	8 min COOK	1 SERVES
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- HIGH PROTEIN
- WEIGHT LOSS
- MUSCLE BUILDING

Best Time to Eat: Breakfast, or a light post-workout meal.

INGREDIENTS

- ✓ 3 egg whites, 1 whole egg
- ✓ Chopped onion, tomato, capsicum
- ✓ Salt, pepper

HEALTH BENEFITS

Using mostly egg whites keeps this omelette lean and high in protein while still delivering the flavour of a whole egg, and the added vegetables bring fibre, vitamin C and antioxidants.

EGG WHITE & VEGETABLE OMELETTE

Method & Finishing Touches

METHOD

Whisk eggs with chopped vegetables, salt and pepper. Cook on a lightly greased pan on low-medium heat, flip once and cook until set. Serve hot.

STORAGE TIPS

Best enjoyed fresh and hot immediately after cooking, as omelettes tend to turn rubbery when reheated.

PRO TIPS

Cook on gentle, even heat and avoid over-flipping — this keeps the omelette tender rather than tough.

“A scatter of fresh herbs and a side of sautéed greens turn this simple omelette into a complete, restaurant-style plate.”

GOOD QUESTIONS

Frequently Asked Questions

Q. Can I prepare these recipes in advance?

Yes. Most batters (moong chilla, besan chilla, ragi dosa, cheela) can be made up to 24 hours ahead and refrigerated. Boiled legumes such as chana, rajma and soya chunks keep for 2-3 days and make assembly nearly instant on a busy morning.

Q. Are these recipes suitable for weight loss?

Many of them are, particularly those tagged 'Weight Loss' in this book — they tend to be higher in protein and fibre relative to calories, which supports fullness. Portion size still matters, so treat the serving sizes given as a helpful guide.

Q. I have PCOS or diabetes — which recipes should I choose?

Look for the 'PCOS Friendly' and 'Diabetes Friendly' tags on each recipe. These favour low-glycemic, fibre-rich ingredients like moong dal, ragi, besan and vegetables. As always, personalise your choices with your doctor or dietitian.

Q. Can I make these recipes vegan?

Several already are. For the paneer, curd, milk or egg-based recipes, you can generally substitute firm tofu for paneer, plant-based yoghurt for curd, and a plant milk of your choice — though exact macros will shift slightly.

Q. How accurate are the calorie and macro numbers?

They are approximate estimates based on standard ingredient quantities, intended as a practical guide rather than a lab-tested figure. Brands, exact weights and cooking methods will all cause some natural variation.

Q. How can I increase the protein content further?

Add an extra egg white, a spoon of curd or hung curd on the side, or a sprinkle of roasted peanuts or seeds to any recipe in this book to boost the protein count by a further 4-8g.

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE

7-Day High Protein Breakfast Meal Plan

A ready-made rotation using recipes from this book

DAY	RECIPE	PROTEIN
Monday	Moong Dal Chilla with Paneer Filling	18g
Tuesday	Egg Bhurji with Multigrain Toast	20g
Wednesday	Sattu Paratha	16g
Thursday	Greek-Style Hung Curd with Nuts & Seeds	15g
Friday	Paneer Bhurji Wrap	18g
Saturday	Ragi Dosa with Peanut Chutney	9g
Sunday	Vegetable & Egg Muffins	16g

HOW TO USE THIS PLAN

Feel free to swap any day for another recipe with a similar protein count and the tags that matter most to you (Weight Loss, PCOS Friendly, Diabetes Friendly). Prep batters and boiled legumes over the weekend using the Meal Planning Tips earlier in this book to make the week effortless.

IN HER OWN WORDS

About Dr. Sayali

I believe that good nutrition should feel like home cooking, not homework. Every recipe in this book was chosen because it is genuinely easy to make on a weekday morning, using ingredients most Indian kitchens already have.

My hope is that The Protein Sunrise becomes less of a cookbook you read once, and more of a kitchen companion you return to — a little dog-eared, a little stained with turmeric, and always within reach.

Thank you for letting these recipes into your morning.

— *Dr. Sayali Nahar*

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PLEASE READ

Disclaimer

The information in this book is intended for general educational purposes only and does not constitute medical or nutritional advice. It is not a substitute for professional consultation, diagnosis, or treatment from a qualified doctor, dietitian, or healthcare provider.

Calorie and macronutrient values provided for each recipe are approximate estimates based on standard ingredient quantities. Actual values may vary depending on brands, exact portion sizes, and cooking methods used.

Individual nutritional needs vary based on age, health status, activity level, and medical history. Please consult your healthcare provider before making significant changes to your diet, particularly if you have a pre-existing medical condition such as PCOS, diabetes, or any other metabolic or hormonal concern.

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